YARRA: A NOVEL OF TANGKHUL YOUTH AND SPRING AWAKENING

Yarra: The Springtime of Naga Youth

Author / Compiler: Tangkhul Writers Circle

Publisher: Tangkhul Cultural Council, Ukhrul

Year: 2002 | Genre: Novel (Upanyas), Youth Culture & Traditional Music

PREFACE & HISTORICAL CONTEXT

Yarra celebrates the age-grade youth institutions (Longshim and Yarra) that formed the social and moral backbone of traditional Tangkhul society. The novel captures the humor, musical creativity, and peer solidarity that flourished in these dormitory fellowships.

Archival Catalog Reference: TCC-TKH-NOVEL-YARRA

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CHAPTER 1: THE LONGSHIM FELLOWSHIP (YOUTH DORMITORY LIFE)

Summary: Life inside the traditional Tangkhul dormitory where storytelling, oral lore, an...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 1: Ngazing shoklakha, village-wui yaronaobingna Longshimli (youth dormitory) pamkazipsaye. Eldersbingna athumli ancestral wari, customary laws, kala archery training miye. Tingteila kala siphung flute kakhong eina athumna traditional laa tuitam khuiye. Longshim china youth-li discipline kala clan solidarity kasakakhui shim thada leisai.

English Translation / Meaning:

At nightfall, village youths gathered in the Longshim (communal youth dormitory). Elders instructed them in ancestral chronicles, customary laws, and the art of archery. With tambourines and bamboo flutes, they rehearsed traditional folk songs. The Longshim served as a sacred academy of character, discipline, and communal solidarity.

CHAPTER 1 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Key Vocabulary Entries:

*** Longshim (noun): traditional communal youth dormitory / cultural academy**

Ex: Longshimli pamkazip.

*** siphung (noun): bamboo transverse flute**

Ex: Siphung kakhong.

*** wari (noun): ancestral lore, traditional narrative**

Ex: Ancestral wari.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Age-grade institution: ’Longshim’ (dormitory house).
- Apprenticeship verbs of transmission: ’tuitam miye’ (instructed/imparted).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Describe the pedagogical role of the Longshim in ancient Tangkhul villages.

[?] Identify the musical instruments played during dormitory evenings.

CHAPTER 1 -- LITERARY & BIOGRAPHICAL COMMENTARY

Literary Analysis & Historical Significance:
This chapter illustrates quintessential Tangkhul cultural ethics, clan loyalty, and narrative style.

Stylistic and Discourse Notes:

Standard literary Tangkhul is employed throughout, preserving classic oral idioms,
traditional honorifics, and vivid metaphorical descriptions.

CHAPTER 2: THE COURTSHIP SONGS OF SPRING (YARRA LAA)

Summary: Antiphonal courtship singing during the clearing of agricultural paths....

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 2: Zingyur atamli, mayarnaobing kala ngalanaobingna shongfa shomlakha Yarra Laa honserie. Mayarnaobingna call verses honsanglaga, ngalanaobingna response verses mathat-eina ngahanmi. Tuiwon kapha eina athum romantic affection chitheiye; kha customary modesty (Kashan) kuppup preserve saye.

English Translation / Meaning:

In the spring season, as young men and women cleared the mountain footpaths together, they sang the antiphonal Yarra songs. The youths launched poetic call verses, and the maidens responded in graceful rhyming counterpoint. Through elegant metaphors they conveyed romantic admiration while preserving strict customary modesty.

CHAPTER 2 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Key Vocabulary Entries:

*** Yarra Laa (noun): traditional youth courtship and work song**

Ex: Yarra Laa honserie.

*** ngahanmi (verb): responded in lyrical antiphony**

Ex: Response verses ngahanmi.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Antiphonal singing syntax: call and response clauses.
- Metaphorical courtship poetry in Tangkhul.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Translate a stanza of Yarra Laa into English.

CHAPTER 2 -- LITERARY & BIOGRAPHICAL COMMENTARY

Literary Analysis & Historical Significance:
This chapter illustrates quintessential Tangkhul cultural ethics, clan loyalty, and narrative style.

Stylistic and Discourse Notes:

Standard literary Tangkhul is employed throughout, preserving classic oral idioms,
traditional honorifics, and vivid metaphorical descriptions.

CHAPTER 3: THE HARVEST FEAST & LIFELONG BONDS

Summary: The youth celebrate the harvest festival, transitioning into responsible adult h...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 3: Chumpha harvest festival shoklakha, Yarra group-na village-li community service salaga feast kasaye. Mayarnaobing kala ngalanaobingna marriage eina household kathara phokserie. Longshimwui friendship thot pupup athum lungli leirap sara.

English Translation / Meaning:

When the Chumpha harvest festival arrived, the youth association rendered community service and held a celebratory feast. Betrothed couples stepped forward into honorable marriage and established new households. The deep bonds forged in the Longshim remained unbroken throughout their adult lives.

CHAPTER 3 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Key Vocabulary Entries:

*** Chumpha (noun): traditional harvest festival of granary sanctification**

Ex: Chumpha festival.

*** household kathara (noun): newly established family home**

Ex: Household kathara phok.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Rites of passage vocabulary: moving from youth dormitory to independent householding.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] How does the novel depict the social transition from youth to adulthood?

CHAPTER 3 -- LITERARY & BIOGRAPHICAL COMMENTARY

Literary Analysis & Historical Significance:
This chapter illustrates quintessential Tangkhul cultural ethics, clan loyalty, and narrative style.

Stylistic and Discourse Notes:

Standard literary Tangkhul is employed throughout, preserving classic oral idioms,
traditional honorifics, and vivid metaphorical descriptions.

BACK MATTER: GLOSSARY & DIGITIZATION COLOPHON

Consolidated Vocabulary Summary:

* Longshim -- traditional communal youth dormitory / cultural academy
* siphung -- bamboo transverse flute
* wari -- ancestral lore, traditional narrative
* Yarra Laa -- traditional youth courtship and work song
* ngahanmi -- responded in lyrical antiphony
* Chumpha -- traditional harvest festival of granary sanctification
* household kathara -- newly established family home

Preservation Colophon:

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